Fancy Bass Chords

and Their Voicings

(B) E A D G

https://fancychords.com

Movable Shapes

Bass closed, so they move

shape	root on	bottom	example
fifths			
02xx	E	R	13xx = F5
x02x	A	R	x13x = Bb5
xx02	D	R	xx13 = Eb5
3x0x	E	R	4x1x = Ab5
major			
02x1	E	R	13x2 = F
320x	E	R	431x = Ab
x320	A	R	x431 = Db
minor			
02x0	E	R	13x1 = Fm
310x	E	R	421x = Abm
x310	A	R	x421 = Dbm

Shape is the fingering above its lowest fret. Slide it one fret, the chord rises a semitone. Bottom is the degree on the lowest string.

Root Positions

Bass

	(B)	E	A	D	G
C	1	8	3	10	5
Db	2	9	4	11	6
D	3	10	5	0	7
Eb	4	11	6	1	8
E	5	0	7	2	9
F	6	1	8	3	10
Gb	7	2	9	4	11
G	8	3	10	5	0
Ab	9	4	11	6	1
A	10	5	0	7	2
Bb	11	6	1	8	3
B	0	7	2	9	4

Fret for the root of each key on each string. Everything else is measured from there.

Patterns

Bass counted from the root

Root + fifth + octave The default. Works under anything in the key.

degree	R	5	8
string	R	1+R	2+R
fret	R0	R2	R2

Major arpeggio Major, maj7, 6.

degree	R	5	8	3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R2	R1

Minor arpeggio Minor, m7, m6.

degree	R	5	8	b3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R2	R0

Dominant seventh Any 7 chord. The b7 pulls to the four.

degree	R	5	b7	3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R0	R1

Minor seventh The two and the six chord.

degree	R	5	b7	b3
string	R	1+R	2+R	3+R
fret	R0	R2	R0	R0

Walking approach Leading into the next chord.

degree	R	5	6	b7
string	R	1+R	1+R	2+R
fret	R0	R2	R4	R0

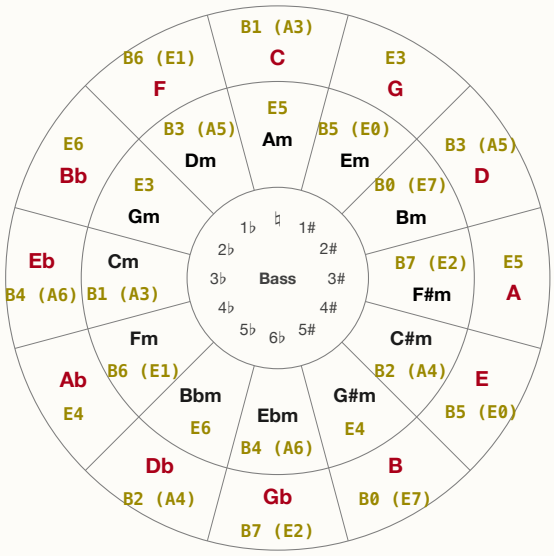
Numbers

Bass the major scale, degree by degree

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7
C	C	D	E	F	G	A	B
Db	Db	Eb	F	Gb	Ab	Bb	C
D	D	E	F#	G	A	B	C#
Eb	Eb	F	G	Ab	Bb	C	D
E	E	F#	G#	A	B	C#	D#
F	F	G	A	Bb	C	D	E
Gb	Gb	Ab	Bb	Cb	Db	Eb	F
G	G	A	B	C	D	E	F#
Ab	Ab	Bb	C	Db	Eb	F	G
A	A	B	C#	D	E	F#	G#
Bb	Bb	C	D	Eb	F	G	A
B	B	C#	D#	E	F#	G#	A#

Read across: in the key on the left, the four is the note under the 4. A minor key borrows the same row, starting from its six.

Bass Circle of Fifths



String and fret for each root: A3 is the third fret of the A string.
Lowest that falls under the hand.
Five-string first, four-string in parentheses.

Tunings

Bass (B) E A D G

The guitar's lowest four strings, an octave down.

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Downloads and a printable copy:
https://fancychords.com

Source and corrections:
http://github.com/linenoise/voicings

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What to Play Under

Bass degrees from the root

major	R 3 5
m	R b3 5
5	R 5
+	R 3 #5
º	R b3 b5
sus2	R 2 5
sus4	R 4 5
6	R 3 5 6
m6	R b3 5 6
6/9	R 9 3 5 6
7	R 3 5 b7
maj7	R 3 5 7
m7	R b3 5 b7
º7	R b3 b5 6
m7b5	R b3 b5 b7
7sus4	R 4 5 b7
7b5	R 3 b5 b7
7#5	R 3 #5 b7
9	R 9 3 5 b7
maj9	R 9 3 5 7
m9	R 9 b3 5 b7
add9	R 9 3 5
madd9	R 9 b3 5
7b9	R b9 3 5 b7
7#9	R b3 3 5 b7
m11	R 9 b3 4 5 b7

Play the root, and the fifth if there is one.
Add the tone that names the chord, the b3 or the b7, only when it wants hearing.
The rest belongs to whoever is playing chords.